

Inequality and Social Mobility - Complete Lesson

C2 · Ages Adults (20-23) · 90 min · Writing · + Critical Thinking

Overview

Learning objective: Write a nuanced policy analysis that separates causal hypotheses from evidence, weighs distributional trade-offs and specifies what would justify revision.

Main skill: Writing

Secondary skill: Critical Thinking

Duration: 90 minutes

Class size: 20 students

Group work: Groups of 4

Success criteria

- State a clear response that meets the task.
- Use specific details from the supplied material.
- Respond to another view and recognize an appropriate limitation.

Materials needed

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- Student worksheets A and B with reading and listening questions; teacher answer keys.
 - Supplied case and situation cards; paper and pens.
 - Full technology (internet, devices, audio). Included recording and student slides.

Teacher preparation

- Read the two scripts and check the teacher keys before teaching.
- Print one selected worksheet version per learner; keep teacher copies separate.
- Prepare the supplied role cards. No outside article or paid material is needed.
- Use the fictional case, not classmates' family income or personal experiences. No external research is required; optional sources must be distinguished from the supplied evidence.

Key language

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- inequality
 - mobility
 - systemic
 - opportunity

- policy
- The observed association is consistent with ____, but cannot by itself establish ____ .
- The policy's merits depend partly on how ____ is distributed and measured.
- Even if ____, it would not follow that ____; an alternative explanation is ____ .

Lesson plan - 90 minutes

8 min - Connect and set the goal

Teacher: Invite an initial view on the case, then state the objective and distinguish the fictional scenario from factual research.

Students: State an initial view and one question you want the case to answer.

Materials: Opening slide or printed opening card

Purpose: Activate prior knowledge without testing unfamiliar language.

12 min - Teach the five key words

Teacher: Model the five terms using their definitions and examples. Ask learners to explain a distinction in their own words.

Students: Complete Section A and compare meanings with a partner.

Materials: Vocabulary cards; worksheet Section A

Purpose: Critical Thinking supports the main writing task.

15 min - Read for meaning

Teacher: Give a first reading for the main situation, followed by the four evidence questions. Clarify only vocabulary essential to meaning.

Students: Read the passage, answer the questions and locate the supporting words.

Materials: Reading passage and four questions, supplied in the worksheet

Purpose: Establish a shared context and check literal understanding before interpretation.

12 min - Listen for a change or decision

Teacher: Play the included recording twice: once for the main situation, then again after learners read the three questions. Use the teacher transcript to resolve disputed evidence.

Students: Identify the main situation, then answer the three detail questions and compare evidence.

Materials: Supplied listening script and questions

Purpose: Practice listening with information that differs from the reading.

16 min - Guided language practice

Teacher: Use Version A Sections B and C. Model one response, then let pairs work. Keep Version B for a later lesson, reassessment or fast finishers. For children, Sections D and E are optional additional practice.

Students: Apply the sentence frames, then respond to the five application prompts.

Materials: Worksheet A; sentence frames; optional worksheet B

Purpose: Move from recognition to usable language.

23 min - A policy hearing with a written dissent

Teacher: Arrange groups of 4. Read the supplied role or situation cards and assign roles. Require a choice, supporting reasons and a response to another view. Monitor using the assessment criteria.

Students: Complete the group task, present your decision and respond to one question.

Materials: All situation cards appear under Activities and on the student slides

Purpose: Demonstrate the objective through a purposeful exchange.

4 min - Exit check and next step

Teacher: Use the three exit prompts. Record which part of the objective needs another model. Explain the short homework; use the separate assessment later if needed.

Students: Give an independent response and identify one point to improve.

Materials: Exit ticket and homework instructions

Purpose: Check individual progress after supported group work.

Classroom activity - A policy hearing with a written dissent

Objective: Write a nuanced policy analysis that separates causal hypotheses from evidence, weighs distributional trade-offs and specifies what would justify revision.

Time: 23 minutes

Grouping: Groups of 4

Materials: Council group: Recommend a limited package using the fictional case only. State whose access improves and who may remain excluded.

Review group: Test the causal assumptions and administrative trade-offs. Do not treat a plausible mechanism as a measured effect.

Final task: Write a joint recommendation and a short dissent that accurately represents the strongest unresolved objection.

Teacher instructions

- Use the exact situation cards below; no additional resource is needed.
- Form groups of 4 and model one short response.

- Allow 18 minutes for preparation and practice; use the remaining time for responses and feedback.
- Score each criterion 0-2: a qualified claim; accurate use of case evidence; a serious alternative explanation; an explicit trade-off; a justified revision condition. 8/10 indicates the task is substantially met. These are task rubrics, not formal CEFR certification.

Student instructions

- Council group: Recommend a limited package using the fictional case only. State whose access improves and who may remain excluded.
- Review group: Test the causal assumptions and administrative trade-offs. Do not treat a plausible mechanism as a measured effect.
- Final task: Write a joint recommendation and a short dissent that accurately represents the strongest unresolved objection.

Example: We support simplified applications and a reviewable evening-transport pilot because both address specified barriers. This is a provisional judgment, not a demonstrated mobility effect. Evaluation should distinguish take-up, completion and later outcomes while documenting who remains excluded.

Variation: Exchange recommendations with another group and write one constructive challenge.

Homework

Continue the learning

Use the lesson materials. No additional purchase or research is required.

- Write a 320-380-word policy analysis with a 60-word dissent.
- Include a rival explanation, a distributional trade-off, an evaluation limit and a revision condition.

Estimated time: 30 minutes

Exit ticket - 4 min

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- Formulate a qualified causal hypothesis about the bus schedule.
 - Specify an outcome and suitable follow-up conceptually.
 - Name one point you would improve in your response.

Success looks like: Score each criterion 0-2: a qualified claim; accurate use of case evidence; a serious alternative explanation; an explicit trade-off; a justified revision condition. 8/10 indicates the task is substantially met. These are task rubrics, not formal CEFR certification.

Teacher notes

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- Score each criterion 0-2: a qualified claim; accurate use of case evidence; a serious alternative explanation; an explicit trade-off; a justified revision condition. 8/10 indicates the task is substantially met. These are task rubrics, not formal CEFR certification.

- Reading and listening tell different stories. Keep their keys separate.
- Student slides include tasks and language models. Facilitation notes and transcript answers belong in the separate teacher documents.

Student worksheet - Version A

Name: _____ Class: _____ Date: _____

Complete the sections your teacher assigns. Use the reading and the supplied case details. Version B is an alternative for later practice.

Section A - Meet the key words

Match each definition to a word from the bank.

Word bank

inequality | mobility | systemic | opportunity | policy

1. An uneven distribution of resources, conditions or outcomes.

2. Movement between social or economic positions.

3. Arising from the organization of connected institutions or practices.

4. A meaningful chance to pursue an outcome.

5. An organized course of action adopted by an institution.

Reading - Equal Eligibility, Unequal Access

Read the passage and answer the questions.

The following municipality, program and observations are fictional. Arden offers a training grant to residents seeking a new qualification. Anyone meeting the same published income and residency criteria may apply. Officials initially describe the policy as equal access because the eligibility rule does not distinguish between neighborhoods. Yet application and completion patterns differ across the municipality. The available case notes report the difference without supplying a representative dataset or identifying its cause.

One explanation emphasizes individual choices: eligible residents may value the course differently or prefer immediate work. Another points to institutional conditions. Classes end after the last bus to two neighborhoods, some applicants lack reliable childcare, and the application requires documents from several offices. These mechanisms could constrain participation even where motivation is strong. Their plausibility, however, is not proof that they explain every non-application or withdrawal.

A proposed universal transport allowance would be simple to administer and avoid requiring participants to demonstrate exceptional need. Critics argue that some funds would go to people who already have adequate transport. A targeted package of evening transport and childcare support might direct more resources toward specific barriers, but it could introduce intrusive eligibility checks, administrative delays and errors that exclude people it is meant to help. A third proposal simplifies the application process for everyone, although simplification alone would not change the bus schedule.

The council must also decide what success means. More applications would show increased take-up, not necessarily qualification completion or lasting mobility. Higher completion among participants would be encouraging, but selection into the program could make a comparison with non-participants misleading. A credible evaluation would need a defensible comparison, attention to who remains excluded and a follow-up period suited to the outcome being claimed.

A balanced recommendation can therefore support action while remaining explicit about uncertainty. The absence of decisive causal evidence need not justify inaction, but neither does a plausible systemic explanation license certainty about a particular remedy. The policy should connect each intervention to an identified barrier, make its distributional choices visible and establish conditions for revision. Equal eligibility is a starting rule; whether it yields meaningful opportunity is an empirical and normative question.

1. Why does the case not establish the cause of different participation rates?

2. Give one mechanism that could restrict participation despite motivation.

3. What is the main administrative trade-off of targeting?

4. Why are more applications insufficient evidence of lasting mobility?

Section B - Language in use

Respond using language that fits the situation.

1. Distinguish an observed disparity from an established cause.

2. Qualify: Non-participation shows a lack of ambition.

3. Identify a systemic mechanism without attributing malicious intent.

4. Separate an empirical claim from a normative judgment about targeting.

5. Explain why take-up is not equivalent to mobility.

Section C - Apply and explain

Give a reason, an example or a case detail when the prompt asks for one.

1. Formulate a qualified causal hypothesis about the bus schedule.

2. Identify evidence that would weaken that hypothesis.

3. Compare universal and targeted support on two dimensions.

4. Specify an outcome and suitable follow-up conceptually.

5. Write a conditional policy thesis that admits uncertainty.

Listening - The Evaluation Adviser's Caution

Listen for meaning, then answer the questions.

1. Which two claims does the adviser reject as established conclusions?

- a) Equal eligibility proves opportunity; unequal participation proves one systemic cause
- b) All grants work; all transport fails
- c) Qualifications are useless; all residents are identical

2. Why is a simple participant comparison insufficient?

- a) People who join may differ from those who do not
- b) Completion cannot be measured
- c) No one applied

3. What trade-off requires an explicit value judgment?

- a) Administrative simplicity versus more targeted support
- b) Whether buses exist
- c) The name of the municipality

Student worksheet - Version B

Name: _____ Class: _____ Date: _____

Complete the sections your teacher assigns. Use the reading and the supplied case details. Version B is an alternative for later practice.

Section A - Use the key words

Write a sentence that shows each word's meaning.

Word bank

inequality | mobility | systemic | opportunity | policy

1. Use "inequality" in a sentence about this lesson.

2. Use "mobility" in a sentence about this lesson.

3. Use "systemic" in a sentence about this lesson.

4. Use "opportunity" in a sentence about this lesson.

5. Use "policy" in a sentence about this lesson.

Reading - Equal Eligibility, Unequal Access

Read the passage and answer the questions.

The following municipality, program and observations are fictional. Arden offers a training grant to residents seeking a new qualification. Anyone meeting the same published income and residency criteria may apply. Officials initially describe the policy as equal access because the eligibility rule does not distinguish between neighborhoods. Yet application and completion patterns differ across the municipality. The available case notes report the difference without supplying a representative dataset or identifying its cause.

One explanation emphasizes individual choices: eligible residents may value the course differently or prefer immediate work. Another points to institutional conditions. Classes end after the last bus to two neighborhoods, some applicants lack reliable childcare, and the application requires documents from several offices. These mechanisms could constrain participation even where motivation is strong. Their plausibility, however, is not proof that they explain every non-application or withdrawal.

A proposed universal transport allowance would be simple to administer and avoid requiring participants to demonstrate exceptional need. Critics argue that some funds would go to people who already have adequate transport. A targeted package of evening transport and childcare support might direct more resources toward specific barriers, but it could introduce intrusive eligibility checks, administrative delays and errors that exclude people it is meant to help. A third proposal simplifies the application process for everyone, although simplification alone would not change the bus schedule.

The council must also decide what success means. More applications would show increased take-up, not necessarily qualification completion or lasting mobility. Higher completion among participants would be encouraging, but selection into the program could make a comparison with non-participants misleading. A credible evaluation would need a defensible comparison, attention to who remains excluded and a follow-up period suited to the outcome being claimed.

A balanced recommendation can therefore support action while remaining explicit about uncertainty. The absence of decisive causal evidence need not justify inaction, but neither does a plausible systemic explanation license certainty about a particular remedy. The policy should connect each intervention to an identified barrier, make its distributional choices visible and establish conditions for revision. Equal eligibility is a starting rule; whether it yields meaningful opportunity is an empirical and normative question.

1. Why does the case not establish the cause of different participation rates?

2. Give one mechanism that could restrict participation despite motivation.

3. What is the main administrative trade-off of targeting?

4. Why are more applications insufficient evidence of lasting mobility?

Section B - Language in use

Respond using language that fits the situation.

1. Correct: Equal eligibility guarantees equal opportunity.

2. State a competing explanation for higher participant completion.

3. Explain an exclusion error in a targeted policy.

4. Give a reason universal provision might be preferred despite leakage.

5. Describe a defensible revision rule without invented evidence.

Section C - Apply and explain

Give a reason, an example or a case detail when the prompt asks for one.

1. Steelman the case for individual choice as one explanation.

2. Explain why that argument does not eliminate systemic constraints.

3. Design one nonintrusive question for prospective participants.

4. State a limit of the fictional evidence.

5. Defend an evaluation strategy while acknowledging an ethical constraint.

Listening - The Evaluation Adviser's Caution

Listen for meaning, then answer the questions.

1. Which two claims does the adviser reject as established conclusions?

- a) Equal eligibility proves opportunity; unequal participation proves one systemic cause
- b) All grants work; all transport fails
- c) Qualifications are useless; all residents are identical

2. Why is a simple participant comparison insufficient?

- a) People who join may differ from those who do not
- b) Completion cannot be measured
- c) No one applied

3. What trade-off requires an explicit value judgment?

- a) Administrative simplicity versus more targeted support
- b) Whether buses exist
- c) The name of the municipality

Teacher answer key

How to run the worksheet

Write a nuanced policy analysis that separates causal hypotheses from evidence, weighs distributional trade-offs and specifies what would justify revision.

Score each criterion 0-2: a qualified claim; accurate use of case evidence; a serious alternative explanation; an explicit trade-off; a justified revision condition. 8/10 indicates the task is substantially met. These are task rubrics, not formal CEFR certification.

Group work guidance

Groups of 4; give everyone a speaking or checking role and rotate. Use Version B as alternate practice, not as a second full worksheet in the same session.

Answers - Version A

Section A - Meet the key words

1. An uneven distribution of resources, conditions or outcomes. -> inequality
2. Movement between social or economic positions. -> mobility
3. Arising from the organization of connected institutions or practices. -> systemic
4. A meaningful chance to pursue an outcome. -> opportunity
5. An organized course of action adopted by an institution. -> policy

Teaching point: Check meaning before form.

Common errors: Answering a different question or giving a claim without the requested detail.

Corrections: Return to the exact prompt. Accept accurate equivalent wording for open responses.

Notes: Answers are in item order. Model responses are examples, not the only acceptable wording.

Reading - Equal Eligibility, Unequal Access

1. Why does the case not establish the cause of different participation rates? -> It provides neither a representative dataset nor a causal identification.
2. Give one mechanism that could restrict participation despite motivation. -> Classes finish after the last bus to two neighborhoods.
3. What is the main administrative trade-off of targeting? -> It may focus resources but add intrusive checks, delays and exclusion errors.
4. Why are more applications insufficient evidence of lasting mobility? -> Take-up is distinct from completion and longer-term outcomes.

Teaching point: Use the passage, not outside knowledge.

Model answers: 1. Evidence: without supplying a representative dataset or identifying its cause | 2. Evidence: Classes end after the last bus to two neighborhoods | 3. Evidence: it could introduce intrusive eligibility checks, administrative delays and errors | 4. Evidence: More applications would show increased take-up, not necessarily qualification completion or lasting mobility.

Common errors: Answering a different question or giving a claim without the requested detail.

Corrections: Return to the exact prompt. Accept accurate equivalent wording for open responses.

Notes: Answers are in item order. Model responses are examples, not the only acceptable wording.

Section B - Language in use

1. Distinguish an observed disparity from an established cause. -> A disparity describes a difference; a causal claim needs evidence about the mechanism and alternatives.
2. Qualify: Non-participation shows a lack of ambition. -> Non-participation may reflect preferences or constraints; the case does not isolate their contributions.
3. Identify a systemic mechanism without attributing malicious intent. -> The class schedule and bus timetable may jointly prevent attendance.
4. Separate an empirical claim from a normative judgment about targeting. -> Whether targeting reaches excluded residents is empirical; how much intrusion is acceptable is normative.
5. Explain why take-up is not equivalent to mobility. -> Applying does not establish completion or a sustained change in social or economic position.

Teaching point: Writing practice with critical thinking support.

Common errors: Answering a different question or giving a claim without the requested detail.

Corrections: Return to the exact prompt. Accept accurate equivalent wording for open responses.

Notes: Answers are in item order. Model responses are examples, not the only acceptable wording.

Section C - Apply and explain

1. Formulate a qualified causal hypothesis about the bus schedule. -> Late class times may reduce attendance for residents dependent on the last bus.
2. Identify evidence that would weaken that hypothesis. -> Affected residents may report and demonstrate a different dominant barrier; check credible attendance and transport information.
3. Compare universal and targeted support on two dimensions. -> Compare reach and administrative burden, while noting exclusion and unused support.
4. Specify an outcome and suitable follow-up conceptually. -> Define completion first and a later work or income outcome; do not equate immediate take-up with mobility.
5. Write a conditional policy thesis that admits uncertainty. -> Support a limited intervention tied to identified barriers, with evaluation and revision conditions.

Teaching point: Writing practice with critical thinking support.

Common errors: Answering a different question or giving a claim without the requested detail.

Corrections: Return to the exact prompt. Accept accurate equivalent wording for open responses.

Notes: Answers are in item order. Model responses are examples, not the only acceptable wording.

Listening - The Evaluation Adviser's Caution

1. Which two claims does the adviser reject as established conclusions? -> Equal eligibility proves opportunity; unequal participation proves one systemic cause
2. Why is a simple participant comparison insufficient? -> People who join may differ from those who do not
3. What trade-off requires an explicit value judgment? -> Administrative simplicity versus more targeted support

Teaching point: Read or listen twice. Answers refer only to this script.

Common errors: Answering a different question or giving a claim without the requested detail.

Corrections: Return to the exact prompt. Accept accurate equivalent wording for open responses.

Notes: Teacher transcript:

I would resist two tempting conclusions about Arden's training grant. One is that equal eligibility proves equal opportunity. The other is that unequal participation proves a single systemic cause. The case supports neither conclusion on its own. It gives us plausible mechanisms that deserve investigation, not a complete causal account.

My recommendation is to simplify the application for everyone while piloting evening transport where the timetable creates an identified barrier. Childcare support should also be considered, but its design needs consultation with prospective participants. We should record who cannot use each intervention and why.

Evaluation must distinguish take-up, completion and longer-term outcomes. An increase in applications would not, by itself, demonstrate social mobility. Nor would a higher completion rate among participants prove that the grant caused the difference, since people who join may differ from those who do not.

There is also a value judgment that evidence cannot make for us: how much administrative simplicity we are willing to exchange for more targeted support. That judgment should be stated openly. I would support a limited, reviewable policy with a clear comparison strategy, rather than promise a permanent solution before we understand the mechanisms. Uncertainty is a reason to design learning into the policy, not a reason to disguise assumptions as findings.

Read the questions aloud for young learners. Replay or reread in short sections if needed.

Answers - Version B

Section A - Use the key words

1. Use "inequality" in a sentence about this lesson. -> Inequality can persist even when a formal rule is equal.
2. Use "mobility" in a sentence about this lesson. -> A mobility measure needs a defined comparison and period.
3. Use "systemic" in a sentence about this lesson. -> A systemic barrier may persist without an explicit exclusion rule.
4. Use "opportunity" in a sentence about this lesson. -> Opportunity depends partly on whether access is usable.
5. Use "policy" in a sentence about this lesson. -> A policy can have different effects on different groups.

Teaching point: Check meaning before form.

Common errors: Answering a different question or giving a claim without the requested detail.

Corrections: Return to the exact prompt. Accept accurate equivalent wording for open responses.

Notes: Answers are in item order. Model responses are examples, not the only acceptable wording.

Reading - Equal Eligibility, Unequal Access

1. Why does the case not establish the cause of different participation rates? -> It provides neither a representative dataset nor a causal identification.
2. Give one mechanism that could restrict participation despite motivation. -> Classes finish after the last bus to two neighborhoods.
3. What is the main administrative trade-off of targeting? -> It may focus resources but add intrusive checks, delays and exclusion errors.
4. Why are more applications insufficient evidence of lasting mobility? -> Take-up is distinct from completion and longer-term outcomes.

Teaching point: Use the passage, not outside knowledge.

Model answers: 1. Evidence: without supplying a representative dataset or identifying its cause | 2. Evidence: Classes end after the last bus to two neighborhoods | 3. Evidence: it could introduce intrusive eligibility checks, administrative delays and errors | 4. Evidence: More applications would show increased take-up, not necessarily qualification completion or lasting mobility.

Common errors: Answering a different question or giving a claim without the requested detail.

Corrections: Return to the exact prompt. Accept accurate equivalent wording for open responses.

Notes: Answers are in item order. Model responses are examples, not the only acceptable wording.

Section B - Language in use

1. Correct: Equal eligibility guarantees equal opportunity. -> Identical formal eligibility may coexist with unequal practical access.
2. State a competing explanation for higher participant completion. -> Participants may begin with different resources or readiness.

3. Explain an exclusion error in a targeted policy. -> Someone who needs support may be incorrectly judged ineligible or unable to complete the process.
4. Give a reason universal provision might be preferred despite leakage. -> It may reduce administrative burden and avoid intrusive checks.
5. Describe a defensible revision rule without invented evidence. -> Review the pilot if intended participants remain unable to attend, while investigating why.

Teaching point: Writing practice with critical thinking support.

Common errors: Answering a different question or giving a claim without the requested detail.

Corrections: Return to the exact prompt. Accept accurate equivalent wording for open responses.

Notes: Answers are in item order. Model responses are examples, not the only acceptable wording.

Section C - Apply and explain

1. Steelman the case for individual choice as one explanation. -> Residents may reasonably prefer immediate work or different training, even when access is practical.
2. Explain why that argument does not eliminate systemic constraints. -> Preferences and institutional barriers can operate simultaneously.
3. Design one nonintrusive question for prospective participants. -> Which scheduling or travel arrangements would make attendance possible for you?
4. State a limit of the fictional evidence. -> No representative dataset or identified causal effect is supplied.
5. Defend an evaluation strategy while acknowledging an ethical constraint. -> Seek a credible comparison without deliberately removing existing support; explain remaining selection limitations.

Teaching point: Writing practice with critical thinking support.

Common errors: Answering a different question or giving a claim without the requested detail.

Corrections: Return to the exact prompt. Accept accurate equivalent wording for open responses.

Notes: Answers are in item order. Model responses are examples, not the only acceptable wording.

Listening - The Evaluation Adviser's Caution

1. Which two claims does the adviser reject as established conclusions? -> Equal eligibility proves opportunity; unequal participation proves one systemic cause
2. Why is a simple participant comparison insufficient? -> People who join may differ from those who do not
3. What trade-off requires an explicit value judgment? -> Administrative simplicity versus more targeted support

Teaching point: Read or listen twice. Answers refer only to this script.

Common errors: Answering a different question or giving a claim without the requested detail.

Corrections: Return to the exact prompt. Accept accurate equivalent wording for open responses.

Notes: Teacher transcript:

I would resist two tempting conclusions about Arden's training grant. One is that equal eligibility proves equal opportunity. The other is that unequal participation proves a single systemic cause. The case supports neither conclusion on its own. It gives us plausible mechanisms that deserve investigation, not a complete causal account.

My recommendation is to simplify the application for everyone while piloting evening transport where the timetable creates an identified barrier. Childcare support should also be considered, but its design needs consultation with prospective participants. We should record who cannot use each intervention and why.

Evaluation must distinguish take-up, completion and longer-term outcomes. An increase in applications would not, by itself, demonstrate social mobility. Nor would a higher completion rate among participants prove that the grant caused the difference, since people who join may differ from those who do not.

There is also a value judgment that evidence cannot make for us: how much administrative simplicity we are willing to exchange for more targeted support. That judgment should be stated openly. I would support a limited, reviewable policy with a clear comparison strategy, rather than promise a permanent solution before we understand the mechanisms. Uncertainty is a reason to design learning into the policy, not a reason to disguise assumptions as findings.

Read the questions aloud for young learners. Replay or reread in short sections if needed.

Assessment answers

-
1. Formulate a qualified causal hypothesis about the bus schedule.

Answer: Late class times may reduce attendance for residents dependent on the last bus.

2. Identify evidence that would weaken that hypothesis.

Answer: Affected residents may report and demonstrate a different dominant barrier; check credible attendance and transport information.

3. Compare universal and targeted support on two dimensions.

Answer: Compare reach and administrative burden, while noting exclusion and unused support.

4. Specify an outcome and suitable follow-up conceptually.

Answer: Define completion first and a later work or income outcome; do not equate immediate take-up with mobility.

5. Write a conditional policy thesis that admits uncertainty.

Answer: Support a limited intervention tied to identified barriers, with evaluation and revision conditions.

Assessment guidance

Score each criterion 0-2: a qualified claim; accurate use of case evidence; a serious alternative explanation; an explicit trade-off; a justified revision condition. 8/10 indicates the task is substantially met. These are task rubrics, not formal CEFR certification.

Support

Reduce the number of ideas to compare while keeping the same reasoning goal.

Sentence frames

- The observed association is consistent with ____, but cannot by itself establish ____.
- The policy's merits depend partly on how ____ is distributed and measured.
- Even if ____, it would not follow that ____; an alternative explanation is ____.

Word bank

- inequality
- mobility
- systemic
- opportunity
- policy

Worked examples

- We support simplified applications and a reviewable evening-transport pilot because both address specified barriers. This is a provisional judgment, not a demonstrated mobility effect. Evaluation should distinguish take-up, completion and later outcomes while documenting who remains excluded.

Smaller steps

- State the situation in one sentence.
- Select one relevant detail.
- Use a frame to explain the response.
- Add a limitation or another view.

Guided practice

- Distinguish an observed disparity from an established cause. Model: A disparity describes a difference; a causal claim needs evidence about the mechanism and alternatives.
- Formulate a qualified causal hypothesis about the bus schedule. Model: Late class times may reduce attendance for residents dependent on the last bus.

Challenge

Extend the same objective with less scaffolding and more independent explanation.

- Explain how the same outcome pattern could arise from two different mechanisms.
- Write a dissent that accepts your opponent's factual premises but disputes the policy trade-off.
- Which assumption does your response depend on?
- What evidence or constraint would change your choice?

Pacing: the package includes more practice than one class needs.

Teach the selected Version A tasks and keep Version B, extension work and the independent assessment for follow-up.

Sensitive or misleading assumptions.

Use the fictional case, not classmates' family income or personal experiences. No external research is required; optional sources must be distinguished from the supplied evidence.

Presentation - teaching notes

Teacher copy. Keep this guide separate from the student PowerPoint. Slide numbers below refer to the numbered lesson slides; an exported slide may continue over several pages.

1. Inequality and Social Mobility

Evaluate causal claims, distinguish outcomes from mechanisms, and defend a conditional policy judgment.

Task: What do you already know about this topic?

Teacher note: Allow thinking time, then invite a response. Accept equivalent language that meets the objective.

Purpose: Build toward the stated learning objective.

2. Today's goal

Write a nuanced policy analysis that separates causal hypotheses from evidence, weighs distributional trade-offs and specifies what would justify revision.

Task: Explain the goal in your own words.

Teacher note: Allow thinking time, then invite a response. Accept equivalent language that meets the objective.

Purpose: Build toward the stated learning objective.

3. inequality

inequality: An uneven distribution of resources, conditions or outcomes.

Inequality can persist even when a formal rule is equal.

Task: Use the word in a new example.

Teacher note: Model "inequality" with the supplied example. Check that learners distinguish the definition from an example.

Purpose: Build toward the stated learning objective.

4. mobility

mobility: Movement between social or economic positions.

A mobility measure needs a defined comparison and period.

Task: Use the word in a new example.

Teacher note: Model "mobility" with the supplied example. Check that learners distinguish the definition from an example.

Purpose: Build toward the stated learning objective.

5. systemic

systemic: Arising from the organization of connected institutions or practices.

A systemic barrier may persist without an explicit exclusion rule.

Task: Use the word in a new example.

Teacher note: Model "systemic" with the supplied example. Check that learners distinguish the definition from an example.

Purpose: Build toward the stated learning objective.

6. opportunity

opportunity: A meaningful chance to pursue an outcome.

Opportunity depends partly on whether access is usable.

Task: Use the word in a new example.

Teacher note: Model "opportunity" with the supplied example. Check that learners distinguish the definition from an example.

Purpose: Build toward the stated learning objective.

7. policy

policy: An organized course of action adopted by an institution.

A policy can have different effects on different groups.

Task: Use the word in a new example.

Teacher note: Model "policy" with the supplied example. Check that learners distinguish the definition from an example.

Purpose: Build toward the stated learning objective.

8. Read and notice

Equal Eligibility, Unequal Access

Task: Why does the case not establish the cause of different participation rates?

Teacher note: Use the full reading printed in both worksheet versions. Check the four reading questions against the separate teacher key.

Purpose: Build toward the stated learning objective.

9. Listen for details

The Evaluation Adviser's Caution

Task: Listen once for the situation, then again for details.

Teacher note: Use the supplied recording or read the exact script in the separate listening teacher copy. Do not display the transcript during the listening check.

Purpose: Build toward the stated learning objective.

10. Useful language

- The observed association is consistent with ____, but cannot by itself establish ____ .
- The policy's merits depend partly on how ____ is distributed and measured.
- Even if ____, it would not follow that ____; an alternative explanation is ____ .

Task: Adapt one frame to the situation.

Teacher note: These are language models, not answers to the reading or listening questions.

Purpose: Build toward the stated learning objective.

11. A policy hearing with a written dissent · 1

Council group: Recommend a limited package using the fictional case only. State whose access improves and who may remain excluded.

Task: Discuss your choice and explain your reason.

Teacher note: Use in the group activity. Use the fictional case, not classmates' family income or personal experiences. No external research is required; optional sources must be distinguished from the supplied evidence.

Purpose: Build toward the stated learning objective.

12. A policy hearing with a written dissent · 2

Review group: Test the causal assumptions and administrative trade-offs. Do not treat a plausible mechanism as a measured effect.

Task: Discuss your choice and explain your reason.

Teacher note: Use in the group activity. Use the fictional case, not classmates' family income or personal experiences. No external research is required; optional sources must be distinguished from the supplied evidence.

Purpose: Build toward the stated learning objective.

13. A policy hearing with a written dissent · 3

Final task: Write a joint recommendation and a short dissent that accurately represents the strongest unresolved objection.

Task: Discuss your choice and explain your reason.

Teacher note: Use in the group activity. Use the fictional case, not classmates' family income or personal experiences. No external research is required; optional sources must be distinguished from the supplied evidence.

Purpose: Build toward the stated learning objective.

14. Your final response

State your choice. Give evidence. Recognize a limitation.

Task: What would make you change your response?

Teacher note: Allow thinking time, then invite a response. Accept equivalent language that meets the objective.

Purpose: Build toward the stated learning objective.